

FORGED STRENGTH STANDARDS

Build Balanced Strength. Expose Weakness. Eliminate Weak Links.

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CHAPTER 1

Introduction

Strength Without Balance Is A Weakness

Most lifters chase bigger numbers.

More weight.

More plates.

More PRs.

Very few ask a much more important question:

Is my strength actually balanced?

You can bench 315 pounds while having shoulders too weak to press overhead efficiently.

You can squat 405 while your posterior chain struggles to deadlift properly.

You can have an impressive chest while your upper back is so underdeveloped that your posture suffers and your shoulders constantly ache.

The body always exposes weaknesses eventually.

Sometimes through stalled progress.

Sometimes through poor aesthetics.

Sometimes through injury.

FORGED Strength Standards exists to stop that before it happens.

Instead of wondering whether you're strong enough, you'll know.

Instead of guessing which muscle group is holding you back, you'll diagnose it.

Instead of adding random accessory exercises, you'll follow targeted correction protocols.

Balanced strength creates balanced physiques.

Balanced strength creates long-term progress.

Balanced strength lasts.

How To Use This Guide

The system is simple.

Step 1

Test your current lifts.

Step 2

Compare them against the strength standards.

Step 3

Use the diagnosis system to identify your weakest links.

Step 4

Follow the correction protocol.

Step 5

Retest after eight weeks.

Repeat forever.

CHAPTER 2

The FORGED Strength Assessment

Before You Build Strength, Measure It

Most lifters train without a roadmap.

They add weight when they can.

They copy workouts from social media.

They guess which muscles need more work.

Then they wonder why progress stalls.

The FORGED Strength Assessment removes the guesswork.

In less than 30 minutes, you'll know:

- How strong you are for your body weight.
- Which lifts are holding you back.
- Which muscles are underdeveloped.
- Where your training should be focused next.

This assessment is the foundation of everything that follows.

Don't skip it.

Step 1

Record Your Stats

Before testing, write down your current information.

Metric	Value
Age	
Height	
Bodyweight	
Training Experience	
Goal	Strength / Muscle / Both

Step 2

Test Your Main Lifts

Record your best lift for each movement.

If you already know your current one-rep max (1RM), use it.

If not, estimate it using a heavy set of 3–8 reps. (You'll include a 1RM estimation chart later in the guide.)

Lift

Weight

Bench Press

Squat

Deadlift

Overhead Press

Barbell Row

Pull-Ups (bodyweight or
weighted)

Safety Note: Never attempt a maximal lift without proper technique, adequate warm-up, and, when appropriate, a spotter. An estimated 1RM is often sufficient for this assessment.

Step 3

Compare to the Standards

Turn to the Strength Standards chapter.

Locate your bodyweight.

Find your performance level for each lift.

Record it below.

Lift

Level

Bench

Squat

Deadlift

OHP

Row

Pull-Up

Step 4

Find Your Weakest Lift

Ask yourself:

- Which lift ranks the lowest?
- Which lift is farthest behind the others?
- Which movement has stalled the longest?

This is your first clue.

But don't stop there.

Strength isn't only about individual lifts.

It's about how they compare to one another.

Step 5

Calculate Your Ratios

Use the formulas in the Diagnosis chapter.

Record each one.

Ratio

Your Score

Bench :

OHP

Squat :

Deadlift

Push : Pull

Upper : Lower

These ratios reveal imbalances that individual lift numbers often hide.

Step 6

Identify Your Weak Link

Once you've compared your lifts and ratios, determine which area needs the most attention.

Check all that apply.

- ☐ Shoulders
 - ☐ Chest
 - ☐ Triceps
 - ☐ Upper Back
 - ☐ Lats
 - ☐ Posterior Chain
 - ☐ Quads
 - ☐ Core
 - ☐ Grip
 - ☐ Overall Pulling Strength
 - ☐ Lower Body
-

Step 7

Choose Your Protocol

Turn to the Weak Point Protocols chapter.

Find the section that matches your weakest area.

Run that protocol for the next 6–8 weeks while continuing your primary training.

Avoid trying to fix every weakness at once.

The fastest progress comes from solving the biggest problem first.

Step 8

Set Your Retest Date

Improvement can only be measured if you test again.

Record today's date and schedule your next assessment.

Assessment

Initial Test

Retest

Retest under similar conditions:

- Similar body weight.
- Same exercise technique.
- Same equipment.
- Proper warm-up.
- Adequate recovery beforehand.

Consistency makes your results meaningful.

Your FORGED Strength Report

Before moving on, complete this summary.

Strongest Lift: _____

Weakest Lift: _____

Primary Imbalance: _____

Protocol Assigned: _____

Retest Date: _____

Main Goal for the Next 8 Weeks:

CHAPTER 3

The FORGED Philosophy

Strength Is More Than One Lift

Too many people define themselves by a single exercise.

"My bench is..."

"My squat is..."

"My deadlift is..."

One lift tells almost nothing.

Your body functions as a system.

When one muscle group falls behind, the rest eventually compensate.

That's where plateaus begin.

That's where injuries begin.

That's where physiques become disproportionate.

Your goal isn't one impressive lift.

Your goal is balanced performance.

The Three Laws of Balanced Strength

Law 1

Every lift reveals another.

A weak overhead press tells a story about your shoulders.

A weak row tells a story about your upper back.

Every lift is information.

Law 2

Your weakest muscle limits your strongest.

Adding another 20 pounds to your bench means little if your shoulders can't stabilize heavier loads.

Weak links always determine the ceiling.

Law 3

Balance creates longevity.

The strongest lifters aren't simply powerful.

They're structurally balanced.

CHAPTER 4

How Strength Really Works

Explanation:

- Progressive overload
- Neural adaptations
- Muscle size vs strength
- Leverages
- Bodyweight considerations
- Recovery
- Fatigue management

Include myths like:

- Bigger muscles always equal more strength
- Deadlifting every week is required
- Maxing out builds strength
- More volume is always better

CHAPTER 5

FORGED Strength Standards

This becomes the core of the guide.

For every lift include:

Bench Press

- Proper technique
- Common mistakes
- Warm-up
- Standard table

Bodyweight	Beginner	Intermediate	Advanced	Elite
130	...	...	...	...

150	...	...	...	...
170	...	...	...	...
190	...	...	...	...
210+	...	...	...	...

Repeat for

- Squat
- Deadlift
- Overhead Press
- Barbell Row
- Pull-Ups

Each lift gets about 3–4 pages.

CHAPTER 6

The Strength Diagnosis System

This is what makes the book unique.

Ratio 1

Bench : Overhead Press

Healthy ratio:

Around **65–75%**

Example

225 Bench

Should correspond to roughly

150–170 OHP (Overhead Press)

If you're significantly below:

Possible weakness:

- Delts
 - Triceps
 - Shoulder stability
-

Ratio 2

Squat : Deadlift

Healthy range:

Deadlift usually exceeds squat by roughly 5–15%.

Interpretation:

Deadlift much lower?

Posterior chain weakness.

Deadlift much higher?

Possible quad weakness.

Ratio 3

Push vs Pull

Bench

-

OHP

Compared to

Rows

-

Pull-ups

Poor pulling strength often predicts:

- Rounded shoulders
 - Shoulder pain
 - Upper-back underdevelopment
 - Poor posture
-

Ratio 4

Upper Body vs Lower Body

Overall development score.

Shows if someone trains legs enough.

Ratio 5

Vertical Push vs Vertical Pull

OHP

vs

Weighted Pull-Up

Great for identifying shoulder or lat weakness.

Ratio 6

Grip Strength

Optional but valuable.

Deadlift

Farmer Carry

Timed Hang

Weak grip often limits total-body strength.

CHAPTER 7

Finding Your Weak Link

Decision tree.

Example:

"My bench is Intermediate."

↓

"My OHP is Beginner."

↓

Diagnosis:

Shoulders limiting pressing strength.

↓

Protocol A.

Another example:

"My squat is Advanced."

↓

"My deadlift is Intermediate."

↓

Protocol C.

CHAPTER 8

Weak Point Protocols

Each weakness gets an entire page.

Weak Shoulders

Signs

Exercises

- Standing OHP
- Dumbbell Press
- Lateral Raise

Programming

Frequency

Recovery

Expected improvement

Weak Triceps

Exercises

- Close-Grip Bench
 - Dips
 - Skull Crushers
-

Weak Upper Back

Exercises

- Chest Supported Row
 - Pull-Ups
 - Face Pulls
-

Weak Lats

Exercises

- Weighted Pull-Ups
 - Lat Pulldown
 - Straight-Arm Pulldown
-

Weak Posterior Chain

Exercises

- Romanian Deadlift
 - Hip Thrust
 - Back Extension
-

Weak Quads

Exercises

- Front Squat
 - Bulgarian Split Squat
 - Leg Press
-

Weak Grip

Exercises

- Farmer Carries

- Dead Hangs
 - Plate Pinches
-

Weak Core

Exercises

- Hanging Leg Raise
 - Ab Wheel
 - Heavy Carries
-

CHAPTER 9

The 8-Week Correction System

A complete progression plan.

Weeks 1–2

Establish volume.

Weeks 3–4

Increase load.

Weeks 5–6

Increase intensity.

Weeks 7–8

Peak.

Retest.

Include progression charts.

CHAPTER 10

Retesting

How to test safely.

Warm-up sequence.

Estimated 1RM formulas.

When NOT to test.

Logging sheet.

Include printable tracking pages.

CHAPTER 11

FAQ

Examples:

Should beginners use this? Yes

Can women use these standards? No, strength is not the same.

Should I max out? Yes, but have a spotter.

What if I fail a lift? No worries, we are learning and improving.

How often should I retest? Every six to eight weeks is the golden range.

Should I cut or bulk while fixing weaknesses? Up to you, weaknesses can be fixed during either.

CHAPTER 12

The FORGED Strength Score

One Number That Reflects Your Overall Strength

One impressive lift doesn't make you a complete lifter.

A 315-pound bench means little if your squat, deadlift, and overhead press lag far behind.

True strength is balanced.

The **FORGED Strength Score** measures how close you are to elite performance across every major movement.

Rather than judging yourself by a single lift, you'll calculate your progress toward becoming a complete athlete.

Your score isn't permanent.

As your lifts improve, so does your rating.

Step 1

Find Your Elite Standards

Using the Strength Standards chapter, locate the **Elite** standard for your bodyweight for each lift.

Record those numbers below.

Lift	Elite Standard
Bench Press	_____
Squat	_____

Deadlift _____

Overhead
Press _____

Barbell Row _____

Pull-Ups _____

Step 2

Record Your Best Lifts

Lift	Your Best Lift
------	----------------

**+Examples
for a 180lb
lifter**

Bench Press	_____ 315
-------------	------------------

Squat	_____ 455
-------	------------------

Deadlift	_____ 545
----------	------------------

Overhead Press _____ **205**

Barbell Row _____ **275**

Pull-Ups _____ **+100**

Step 3

Calculate Your Percentage

Use the following formula for each lift:

Your Lift ÷ Elite Standard × 100

Example

Bench Press

Your Bench = **250 lb**

Elite Standard = **315 lb**

$250 \div 315 \times 100 = 79\%$

Repeat this calculation for every lift.

Your FORGED Strength Score

Lift	Percentage
------	------------

Bench Press _____ %

Squat _____ %

Deadlift _____ %

Overhead
Press _____ %

Barbell Row _____ %

Pull-Ups _____ %

Step 4

Calculate Your Overall Score

Add all six percentages together.

Then divide by **6**.

Example

Bench = 79%

Squat = 72%

Deadlift = 84%

OHP = 75%

Row = 81%

Pull-Up = 89%

Overall Score

$$(79 + 72 + 84 + 75 + 81 + 89) \div 6$$

= **80%**

That number is your **FORGED Strength Score**.

Your Rank

Score	Rank
0–25%	Iron
26–40%	Steel
41–55%	Bronze
56–70%	Silver
71–85%	Gold
86–95%	Titan
96–100%	FORGED

What Your Rank Means

Iron (0–25%)

You're building your foundation. Focus on mastering technique, consistency, and progressive overload before chasing heavy numbers.

Steel (26–40%)

You've developed a base of strength. Continue improving your movement patterns while building muscle across your entire body.

Bronze (41–55%)

Your lifts are becoming respectable. Eliminate weak links and continue progressing steadily.

Silver (56–70%)

You're stronger than the average gym-goer. At this stage, balanced development becomes increasingly important.

Gold (71–85%)

You've built an impressive level of strength across every major movement. Small improvements now require greater attention to recovery, programming, and technique.

Titan (86–95%)

Elite-level strength is within reach. Your focus should be refining weaknesses and maintaining balance while continuing to push your limits.

FORGED (96–100%)

You've reached an exceptional level of balanced strength. Every major lift reflects years of discipline, intelligent programming, and relentless consistency. Few lifters will ever achieve this standard.

Track Your Progress

Assessment

Score

Initial _____ %
Assessment

1st Retest _____ %

2nd Retest _____ %

3rd Retest _____ %

4th Retest _____ %

Your goal isn't simply to raise one lift.

It's to raise **all** of them.

The strongest athletes aren't defined by a single personal record—they're defined by **balanced, complete strength**.

Improve your score.

Eliminate your weak links.

Become **FORGED**.

CHAPTER 13

Final Thoughts

Strength isn't about impressing other people.

It's about building a body with no obvious weaknesses.

When every major movement progresses together, your physique improves, your lifts continue climbing, and injuries become less likely.

Your goal isn't simply to become stronger.

It's to become complete.

Strong everywhere.

Weak nowhere.

That's what it means to be **FORGED**.

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